

you invest \$1 in your twenties than \$10 in your forties. It is, however, important to speak about context: if someone is barely able to afford their basic needs, then those needs should come before investing. But if you have a spare \$50 at the end of the month that you don't need for the next three to five years, then it's not 'meaningless' to consider investing it.

Now, you would be forgiven for thinking you need \$10 000 in order to invest. Not too long ago, to begin your investing journey, you really only had access to mutual funds — a pool of investments, such as shares of different companies, held in a basket — where the minimum to invest ranged from \$1000 to \$10 000. Fund managers made money through percentages of their clients' portfolios, so in their defence it made sense for them to take on clients with larger pools of money. Think about it: would you rather work with five people with \$50 000 each or 500 people with \$500 each? Fair enough.

However, now there is this beautiful thing called fractional shares. Fractional shares allows you to buy a per cent of a share. If an Alphabet share (Google's parent company) was \$1000, you don't have to wait to save up \$1000 to buy one share. You can put in \$10 and get 1 per cent of a Google share. Now, technically even \$1 is enough to allow people to become investors in any company!

You may be wondering how on earth 1 per cent of a share is going to help you achieve financial freedom, but the benefit of owning even a fractional share is that your money goes up and down the same percentage that the entire share would.

For example, if Google returned 20 per cent in a year, someone owning \$1000 worth of Google would get a 20 per cent return on their money, but so would someone owning only \$10 worth of Google stocks. You don't have to wait to save up to be 'in the market' and have your money beginning to work for you.

The barrier to entry has never been lower. Investing is no longer just for the few rich and wealthy individuals who have a spare \$10 000. Anyone can now have the chance to grow their investing portfolio, become an investor and create wealth for themselves in a way that doesn't rely on them exchanging time for money.